

## Point of view: Major consumers and demand trends in educational training products industry

Technical training institutes are the largest contributors for growth in this segment. IITs, NITs, private engineering under-graduate and post-graduate colleges, diploma colleges, vocational training institutes and other universities are the main consumers. Private training institutes also contribute to the consumption. Hobbyists are also contributing to consumption.

Presently, training systems around embedded systems (FPGAs, ARMs, VLSI, DSPs), instrumentation, process-control, mechatronics and advanced communication are in great demand. There is a steady demand for conventional technologies like microprocessor and microcontroller products. These demands are market-driven since the industry is looking for workforce trained with one of the above technologies to cut-short their in-company training requirements.

—Rajesh Suresh Joshi, director, Dynalog Didactic Solutions Pvt Ltd

## Find the right training institute with EFY's Training Institute Finder

With the capability to search for training institutes city-wise, course-wise and name-wise, Training Institute Finder was created to make it easy for aspirants looking to enrol in an electronics-related course. Currently in its beta version, it provides a comprehensive listing of 550 institutes in India. This facility can be found at [www.electronicsforu.com](http://www.electronicsforu.com) under Finder tab.

started weekend programmes for such professionals. They get trained on core aspects of VLSI design."

Seeing the rising demand from the industry for professionals trained in embedded electronics, RV-VLSI has also launched an embedded programme keeping in mind the requirements of the industry. "Our embedded courses are designed to make people specialists in areas of firmware development, network stack engineering, board support package and Linux device driver development," Prasad adds.

## Steady growth, business-wise

Most engineering colleges and, to some extent, polytechnic colleges

across the country have not connected students to the right kind of job profile in the last three to four years, feels Arulselvan. There is no big growth in electronics-related training as potential candidates are getting diverted towards other job profiles. He says, "There is a big percentage of electronic graduates who are working in various industries like IT and banking, except electronics."

"There is lack of core engineering jobs, which has a telling effect on the admission for electronics-related training courses," he adds.

"NTTF is maintaining steady business, although we are not seeing a big jump. We have not moved away from our basic principle, which is training for employability and connecting them to the industry," informs Arulselvan.

Satish B.K., senior manager - training services, Sandeepani School of VLSI and Embedded Systems Design, says, "As a training institute, we have definitely seen steady growth in business."

## Business models

Talking about an emerging model at Sandeepani School of VLSI and Embedded Systems Design, Satish says,

"We are focusing on blended learning, which is a combination of instructor-led training (ILT) and supporting students with learning management systems (LMSes). This aims at providing trainees an out-of-the-classroom kind of training experience, focusing on self-paced learning (SPL)."

He adds, "Basically, it is a mix of online and instructor training including hands-on, practical lab sessions. We are trying to reach out to educational institutions and conduct training courses in colleges as well to bridge the industry-academia gap."

Arulselvan identifies that the most simple business model is to tie up with the industry. He says, "We have tied up with nearly 150 companies, which regularly visit NTTF for recruitment."

NTTF recently worked on a model called Earn and Learn programme with many companies. Based on Germany's dual education system, it allows people to develop practical skills while working. "Students spend close to five days a week in the industry, focusing on manufacturing-related activities of the company, and one to one-and-a-half day is spent on training at our institute. At the end of this four-year programme, they get good industrial exposure and a diploma certificate," says Arulselvan. He adds, "This programme is free of cost and trainees are paid a stipend. It has picked up very well in the last few years."

According to Prasad, the only business model which has survived the test of time is setting up an industry-like atmosphere and working in partnership with colleges and universities. He says, "RV-VLSI was set up in a similar way. R.V. TRUST provided the land and infrastructure, whereas the technical expertise came from a company of my own, Nanochip Solu-

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